

Chapter 100-1

Would death really make this world a better place?

This was a question without an answer.

But it was the question Qi Jiao asked when she was on the brink of despair.

Liang Shi hadn't expected that Rainbow even knew Morse code. Her young, childish voice rang out inside the car, reading haltingly with occasional strange pauses between phrases, yet she could still express the complete meaning.

As she translated, Liang Shi typed every word she said into the notes app on her phone, then connected them into that one sentence.

This was a diary entry without a year written on it. Reading it, it seemed to be something of Qi Jiao's.

After Rainbow finished reading, she asked Liang Shi, "Sister Liang, do I need to continue?"

Liang Shi shook her head. "No need."

She gathered all the papers, planning to look into it herself when she got back, but couldn't help being curious about Rainbow. "How do you even know Morse code?"

Rainbow pressed her lips together. "I was bored at home before and found a book to read."

Liang Shi was surprised. "And you really memorized it all?"

"I can remember about 90%," Rainbow said.

Liang Shi had always thought that when Zhou Li mentioned photographic memory, it was just relative to children of that age group—not that she could truly remember everything.

If she could really reach that level, what kind of heaven-defying memory would that be?

But now Liang Shi realized that Rainbow's memory really did seem heaven-defying.

"How many times did you read that book?" Liang Shi asked.

"Twice," Rainbow said.

"This kid has photographic memory?" Liang Xinzhou, who was driving up front, couldn't help but interject after hearing their conversation.

Liang Shi responded with an "mm," suddenly feeling a bit worried. "Big Brother, do you think someone like her—could her brain become overloaded?"

"Perhaps you know there's a condition in this world called hyperthymesia?"¹ Liang Xinzhou asked in return.

Liang Shi: "....."

"As time passes, the human brain gradually filters out unimportant things—what people call memories slowly fading." Liang Xinzhou's car had just stopped to wait for a red light, and he tapped his fingers on the steering wheel while glancing at Rainbow sitting in the back seat through the rearview mirror.

She was a very well-behaved little girl, quiet and polite.

Liang Xinzhou looked away and continued driving forward the instant the light turned green. "But people with hyperthymesia cannot forget—whether it's good things or bad things. They have no way to filter their memories. Happiness is doubled, but pain is also doubled. As for effects on the body, I haven't heard of any."

Liang Shi's heart jolted, and she looked at Rainbow, only to see her lips pressed even tighter, fear showing in her eyes.

Liang Shi immediately said, "Big Brother!"

Liang Xinzhou fell silent, also realizing his slip of the tongue. After a moment, he said, "However, there are more geniuses in this world than people with hyperthymesia. This little girl should just be a genius with photographic memory."

Liang Shi nodded in agreement. "Definitely."

But Rainbow still couldn't feel happy no matter what. However, she lowered her eyes, took a deep breath, adjusted herself, and only then raised her head again. "Sister Liang, was that diary written by Teacher Qi?"

Liang Shi paused for a moment. "It wasn't hers. It was someone else's."

Rainbow let out an "oh" and didn't ask further, just looking somewhat low in spirits.

Liang Shi, disturbed by that diary entry, quietly comforted her with a few words. Rainbow said she was fine, then hugged her arms and curled up in the middle of the back seat.

Liang Shi then opened her phone to search for Morse code.

The reason she didn't want Rainbow to continue translating was also because she was afraid there would be too many dark things in the diary. Children were young after all and didn't understand the true meaning of aging, depression, death, and pain.

Even though she had debated with Rainbow before, Liang Shi still held firm to her view.

Children should grow up in an environment filled with love and sunshine. Even if there was pain, depression, and sadness in this world, children shouldn't have to bear it.

Children should grow up carefree.

Because she hadn't been able to grow up in a carefree environment, if she ever had a child, she would definitely do everything in her power to create a carefree environment for them.

With flowers, sunshine, and endless love.

Liang Shi searched for a website that could translate Morse code, but it was a paid service.

She bookmarked the website, planning to deal with it when she got back.

Meanwhile, Ling Dang, who had been sitting beside them watching the whole thing without knowing what had happened, nudged Rainbow's arm and leaned over to whisper, "Zhou Caihong², what's wrong?"

Rainbow replied in a muffled voice, "Nothing."

"Are you unhappy?" Ling Dang whispered by her ear. "Is it because of what my uncle said about that illness?"

Rainbow pressed her lips together and didn't answer her, but then Ling Dang said, "My uncle often scares people like that. When I was four and couldn't memorize my texts, he even called me a dummy."

"My mom says there are ordinary people and geniuses in this world." Ling Dang giggled. "So I'm an ordinary person, and you're a genius. Geniuses don't have worries."

Rainbow: "....."

Ling Dang fished around in her pocket, her chubby little hand tightly clutching something, and told Rainbow to hold out her hand.

Rainbow skeptically held out her hand.

Ling Dang opened her hand, and a White Rabbit milk candy³ dropped into Rainbow's palm.

"There's nothing one piece of candy can't solve," Ling Dang said. "If there is, then make it two pieces."

Rainbow paused. Her hands hesitated while unwrapping the candy paper, but she still said, "Then why did you cry for two days?"

Ling Dang: "....."

Liang Shi, who had been sitting beside them listening to their chat with nothing else to do: "?"

1. Hyperthymnesia (超憶症): A rare condition where a person possesses superior autobiographical memory, allowing them to recall an abnormally vast number of their life experiences in vivid detail. Unlike people with good memories who can choose what to remember, those with hyperthymnesia cannot filter their memories and remember both positive and negative experiences with equal intensity. ⇐
2. Zhou Caihong (周彩虹): "Caihong" means "rainbow" in Chinese. This is Rainbow's Chinese name—her English name "Rainbow" is a translation of her Chinese name. ⇐
3. White Rabbit milk candy (大白兔奶糖): A famous Chinese candy brand known for its creamy, chewy milk-flavored candies. These candies have been a beloved childhood treat in China for decades and are often associated with nostalgia and comfort. ⇐